



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 19

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Pump Jack & Baker Scaffold Safety

OVERVIEW:

Pump jacks and baker scaffolds allow finish carpenters to work safely and efficiently at height for extended horizontal work — chair rail, wainscoting, ceiling trim, and crown molding. But scaffold failures — caused by poor setup, overloading, or damaged planking — can cause multiple workers to fall

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Scaffold planks are the most failure-prone component in a scaffold system. Wood planks can split along the grain, crack at knots, or rot from moisture exposure — and none of these failures are always visible from the surface. Before placing any plank on a scaffold, inspect both faces and both ends. A crack, large knot, or discoloration can indicate hidden weakness. Span scaffold planks
2. Load capacity must be understood before anyone steps onto a scaffold. Baker scaffolds have a rated load in pounds — typically 750 to 1,000 pounds for a standard unit. That includes the weight of every worker, every tool, and every piece of material on the platform at one time. Never exceed the rated load. Never allow more workers on the platform than the load calculation supports.
3. All guardrails, mid-rails, and toe boards must be in place before anyone steps onto the platform. Guardrails prevent falls. Toe boards prevent tools and materials from rolling off the edge and striking workers below. These are not optional components to skip when you are in a hurry. If a guardrail component is missing or damaged, the scaffold is not safe to use. Stop and correct it
4. Never move a baker scaffold or pump jack while workers or materials are on it. Moving a scaffold requires taking everything off, rolling it to the new position, verifying it is on level and stable ground, and then reloading. It takes more time than moving with the load, but a scaffold that tips during movement can injure multiple workers at once. Make the time to do it right.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: How do we verify that a pump jack is properly set up and rated for our crew and materials?
Q2: What do you do if you discover a damaged scaffold plank while you are already up on the platform?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Inspect all planks — cracks, knots, or rot can cause sudden failure
- Never exceed the rated load capacity of any scaffold system
- Ensure all legs are on solid, level footing before anyone climbs
- All guardrails, mid-rails, and toe boards must be installed before use
- Never move a scaffold while workers or materials are on top of it

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 19

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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